



# Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/21

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2023

INSERT

2 hours

## INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

**Text A: We should replace old buildings with new, better ones**

Many older buildings, including some of our homes, schools and offices, were designed and constructed for very different generations, with completely different expectations in terms of lifestyle, comfort, connectivity and energy efficiency.

Empty historic buildings that were once local landmarks now get in the way of new projects (such as repurposing of the land for parks, shops and recreational space) that might offer more benefit to the community. If a building looks old and abandoned and you can't find any good reason to keep it, then you should consider demolishing and replacing it. 5

Buildings often outlive their original purposes. Even when still in use, the enormous cost of repairing some very old buildings can be prohibitive, so they become shabby and unsightly. Some older buildings may still look good on the outside, but have underlying problems such as poor ventilation, outdated wiring and problems with the plumbing. Old buildings also tend to develop weaker foundations, thanks to the materials used in their construction degrading to the point that the structure becomes unstable or unsafe. 10

Constructing new, environmentally friendly 'green' buildings, which can be designed for flexibility of purpose, is the obvious answer. Green buildings use as little energy as possible, generate their own power, recycle water and can heat or cool themselves without the need for air-conditioning or central heating. They also take account of how they affect the people living and working in them. 15

'The goal is to build more buildings that are more physically healthy for people,' says award-winning architect, Joy Yang. 'Numerous studies show how a "healthy building" can reduce illness and absenteeism among workers, increase worker productivity, raise test scores among students and lead to greater workplace satisfaction.' 20

Modern software enables architects and engineers to visualise and calculate increasingly complex shapes, so building designs are no longer limited by practicalities. Weird and wonderful modern buildings in natural shapes are springing up, driven by cities' desire to outdo each other: a football stadium in the shape of a giant flower and an office development shaped like a mountain range. 25

'We're trying to change how people think about buildings,' Yang says. 'We must recognise that our cities are not museums, but living and evolving centres of commerce and culture.'

## Text B: Recycling old buildings

Internationally, old buildings are considered valuable resources. They add charm and human scale to our cities and towns, attracting tourists and businesses and connecting us to our past. They should be protected.

As populations grow, and cities around the world become increasingly built-up, interchangeable and bland, saving not just iconic or famous buildings, but those we have grown up with around us, is critical. They are living history. History we can feel and touch. 5

Some people argue that it is better for the climate to demolish an old energy-hungry building and build a well-insulated, sustainable replacement. Others argue that we should try to find new life in old buildings. 'Adaptive reuse' is a process that 'recycles' old buildings for new uses while retaining many of their historic features, but older buildings have a far more enduring importance to society as educational examples than they do as modern dwellings or workplaces. 10

Admittedly, through adaptive reuse, exciting new spaces have been created in unlikely old buildings, such as former factories, sewage silos and power-stations. However, sometimes this is achieved by traditional restoration of just the building's exterior, and the interior is gutted to create room for the sort of amenities people expect in a new property. Whether this is relevant or possible depends on the history, significance and structure of the building itself, as well as where it is. Some buildings must be entirely restored and repaired sensitively, at considerable expense, before any upgrading for contemporary use is possible. 15

The most successful projects are those that respect and retain the building's heritage but add contemporary features that provide value for the future. We see former warehouses transformed into attractive workplace environments, with green living roofs of plants and grasses, and disused theatres repurposed as open office spaces with their grand staircases retained to encourage physical activity. Sometimes, adaptive reuse is the only way that the building's fabric will be properly cared for, while making better use of the building itself. 20

When properly renovated to incorporate modern, green technologies, old buildings can even use less energy than flashy new buildings that may take decades to save more emissions than were created during their construction. 25

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## FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/21

## Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2023

**2 hours**

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need:    Insert (enclosed)

## INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:  
Section A: answer Question 1.  
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

## INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [ ].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

### Question 1

**Write the speech** you give to a meeting of local people, expressing your views.

- evaluate the ideas, attitudes and opinions about buildings given in both texts
- based on what you have read, justify your views on whether the school's old building should be replaced or reused.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

[illegible]







**[Turn to page 6 for Section B]**

**Section B: Composition**

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

**Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer, and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.**

**EITHER**

**Descriptive Writing**

**2** Describe a theme park or attraction when it is open and when it is closed.

**OR**

**Descriptive Writing**

**3** Describe a group of people meeting to rehearse or practise.

**OR**

**Narrative Writing**

**4** Write a story that includes the words, '... I realised it was my responsibility ...'.

**OR**

**Narrative Writing**

**5** Write a story with the title, 'The portrait'.

This image shows a full page of a handwriting practice worksheet. It consists of approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is defined by two parallel dashed lines, creating a series of uniform gaps for letter height. The lines are evenly spaced across the entire page, providing a guide for consistent letter formation. There is no text or other markings on the page.





Blank lined paper for writing.

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